

Lakeshore Mutual Health

Utilization Management Department
900 North Harbor Drive
Chicago, Illinois 60601
Member Services: (800) 555-0147

Mary Lou Bevredeau
1427 Willow Bend Lane
Palatine, IL 60067

REFERENCE
Member ID: LMH-448219037
Prior Authorization #: PA-2026-0219884
Letter Date: 02/27/2026

cc: Anita Kessler, MD, Northshore Spine Institute, 2200 Lakeview Parkway, Suite 300, Northbrook, IL 60062

RE: Member: Mary Lou Bevredeau (DOB 06/21/1961)
Requesting Provider: Anita Kessler, MD, Northshore Spine Institute
Request Received: 02/12/2026
Service Reviewed: L5-S1 lumbar spinal fusion
Procedure: Posterior lumbar interbody fusion (PLIF), single level; CPT 22630
Planned Date of Service: 03/14/2026
Determination: **DENIED IN FULL - Not medically necessary**
Medical Policy: MP-214: Lumbar Spinal Fusion

Dear Ms. Bevredeau:

Lakeshore Mutual Health has completed its review of the prior authorization request submitted on your behalf by Dr. Kessler for the service referenced above. After review of the clinical information provided with the request, we have determined that the requested service is **not medically necessary** under Lakeshore Mutual Health medical policy MP-214 (Lumbar Spinal Fusion). The request is therefore **denied in full**, and Lakeshore Mutual Health will not provide payment for this service or for associated facility, anesthesia, or assistant surgeon charges.

This determination was made by a physician reviewer who applied the criteria in MP-214 to the records submitted. The specific reasons for this decision are set out on the following page. This is a coverage decision only. It is not a decision about whether you should receive the service; that decision is between you and your doctor.

If you or your provider have additional information that was not included with the original request, you may submit it with an appeal. Your appeal rights are described at the end of this letter.

Reasons for Denial

The physician reviewer made the following findings based on the records submitted with the request:

1. Medical policy MP-214 requires documentation of **at least 6 months** of failed conservative care before lumbar spinal fusion can be considered medically necessary. The records submitted do not demonstrate that this requirement has been met.
2. The records reflect **only 4 weeks of physical therapy documented**. A complete, supervised course of physical therapy with documented response is a required component of conservative care under MP-214.
3. There is **no interventional pain management attempted** in the submitted records (for example, epidural steroid injection or other image-guided spinal injection).

Based on these findings, the requested procedure does not meet the medical necessity criteria of MP-214 and is denied. A copy of MP-214 and of the records used in this review is available to you free of charge upon request.

Sincerely,

Helen Marsh, MD
Board-certified, Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation
Physician Reviewer, Utilization Management
Lakeshore Mutual Health
Review completed: 02/27/2026

YOUR APPEAL RIGHTS

Time limit. You have **180 days** from the date of this letter to file an appeal. You, your authorized representative, or your provider may file on your behalf.

Peer-to-peer review. Your treating physician has the right to request a peer-to-peer discussion with the physician reviewer by calling (800) 555-0162, Monday through Friday, 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. Central Time.

Expedited appeal. If waiting for a standard appeal could seriously jeopardize your health, you or your doctor may request an expedited (72-hour) appeal by phone.

Independent external review. If your appeal is denied, you may have the right to request review by an independent review organization.

Mail written appeals to: Lakeshore Mutual Health, Attn: Appeals Department, P.O. Box 4410, Chicago, IL 60680-4410. **Phone:** (800) 555-0147. **Fax:** (800) 555-0188. Please include your Member ID and Prior Authorization number on all correspondence.